

IT Access and Identity Management Policy

Policy ID	IT-IAM-101	Owner	Information Technology
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Employees, contractors, managers, and system owners	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy governs account creation, authentication, role-based access, privileged access, access reviews, transfers, and termination. Access is based on approved business need and must follow least-privilege principles.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Access type	Approver	Review frequency	Maximum default duration
Standard applications	Manager	Annually	Employment duration
Sensitive business systems	Manager and system owner	Quarterly	12 months
Privileged access	System owner and Security	Monthly	90 days
Emergency access	Incident commander	After each use	24 hours

3. Account Provisioning

A manager initiates access through the IT service portal using the employee's confirmed start date and role. Standard email and portal access are normally available by the first working day. Access to financial, customer, production, or restricted systems requires the applicable system owner. Shared user accounts are prohibited unless Security approves a documented technical exception.

4. Authentication

Users must change temporary credentials when prompted and use multi-factor authentication where required. Passwords, authentication codes, recovery keys, and hardware tokens must not be shared. Suspected credential exposure must be reported immediately. IT may reset credentials or suspend access while investigating risk.

5. Transfers and Access Reviews

Managers must request access changes before a transfer takes effect. Access from the former role should be removed unless the system owner documents a continuing need. System owners complete reviews at the frequency shown in the table and remove access that is unused, excessive, expired, or no longer supported by an active worker record.

6. Privileged and Emergency Access

Administrative work must use a separate privileged identity where technically supported. Privileged access is time-limited, logged, and reviewed. Emergency access may be granted to restore service or respond to an incident, but the approver, reason, actions, and end time must be documented within one working day.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Information Security and Data Handling Policy; Acceptable Use and Device Policy; Offboarding and Company Property Return Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.